CASH TO COMPANY · GRADE 10

a FlexLifeFi K-12 program

The Workbook for the Year

Activities, sort tasks, and reflection prompts you'll keep.

Grade 10 year theme — Ownership, Money, and Compliance.
The 9-12 band is built for the adults who will scrutinize: parents, teachers, administrators.

9-12 BAND · HIGH SCHOOL

STUDENT ACTIVITY BOOK

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GRADE 10 · STUDENT ACTIVITY BOOK

The Workbook for the Year

The legal, financial, and operational chassis under every venture.

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Welcome.

WITH CASH - 9-12 VOICE

"Most adults skip this step. You won't."

This is your activity book for the year. It's the place to do the work that turns big ideas into real artifacts you've made — a categorization, a funding comparison, an operating agreement, a brand guide, a premortem, a compliance map, a vision pitch.

Cash, your animated guide for the year, will pop up between sections to ask the questions that matter. Cash never tells you what to do — Cash asks what your evidence says. Get used to the question: **which people, and how do you know? Show me the evidence.**

This book mirrors the four units. Each unit has activities, projects, and reflection prompts. You'll also keep a Capstone Journal in a separate notebook — the place where you sketch, draft, and reflect. This book is the structured part. The journal is the messy part. You need both.

A note about this year specifically: we're going to teach you about LLCs, operating agreements, sales tax, and friends-and-family loans. We'll teach you what they are, how they work, and what tradeoffs they involve. We will not tell you to form one, take one, or sign one. Decisions about real ventures are family decisions and outside this curriculum. We're building literacy, not making your calls.

How to use this book

> "Some of this is hard because the world's hard. The skill is knowing what's in your hands."
>
> - CASH, GRADE 10

- **Date every entry.** Future-you will care, especially when you're comparing your Day 1 thinking to your Week 36 thinking.
- **Cite your sources.** When you reference a sales-tax rate, a loan APR, a state filing fee — name the source. A made-up number isn't analysis.
- **Don't skip the reflection prompts.** They look optional. They are not.

- **It's okay to be wrong.** Being wrong on Day 1 is the deal. The point of evidence is to find out where you were wrong, fast.
- **Hypotheticals only.** When an activity asks about a venture or a partner, use a hypothetical scenario unless your teacher tells you otherwise. We don't ask about your family's money. Ever.

Unit 1 — What kind of thing is this?

Activity 1.1 — Day 1 Capstone Categorization

Fill in this sentence about your imagined Capstone venture:

"My Capstone is a [circle one: hobby / side hustle / small business / startup] because _____ and _____."

One thing that could shift my categorization in either direction:

Predict: In Week 8, will your category change? Circle one.

STAYS	SHIFTS	NOT SURE

Activity 1.2 — The Four-Category Definitions (Frayer-style)

For each category, fill in: definition, examples, what it's NOT, and one distinguishing question.

HOBBY

Definition	Examples

Not a hobby if...	One distinguishing question

SIDE HUSTLE

Definition	Examples

Not a side hustle if...	One distinguishing question

SMALL BUSINESS

Definition	Examples

Not a small business if...	One distinguishing question

STARTUP

Definition	Examples

Not a startup if...	One distinguishing question

Activity 1.3 — Four-Case Categorization Pack (Checkpoint 1)

For each case profile from the program assets, fill out:

Case #	Category (one of four)	Evidence 1 (specific)	Evidence 2 (specific, different from #1)	What would change my mind?
1 — Hobby case				
2 — Side hustle case				
3 — Small business case				
4 — Startup case				

NOW CATEGORIZE YOUR CAPSTONE:

Category	Evidence 1	Evidence 2	What would change my mind?

Reflection (3–4 sentences): What changed between your Day 1 Categorization and this one? If nothing changed, what evidence do you have that you were right the first time?

Activity 1.4 — The "What Would Have to Be True" Test

For your Capstone, write three statements that would have to be true for it to genuinely be each of the other three categories. (E.g., if you said "side hustle," write what would have to be true for it to be a hobby, a small business, or a startup.)

For it to be a HOBBY, this would have to be true: _____

For it to be a SIDE HUSTLE, this would have to be true: _____

For it to be a SMALL BUSINESS, this would have to be true: _____

For it to be a STARTUP, this would have to be true: _____

AN INTERLUDE · GRADE 10

"Which people, and how do you know?"

the program's spine question.

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Unit 2 — Money in, money out, on whose terms

Activity 2.1 — APR Math Worksheet

For each row, compute the monthly payment and total interest paid using the formula or the spreadsheet template:

`Monthly payment ≈ (Principal × monthly rate) / (1 − (1 + monthly rate)^−n)`

Where monthly rate = APR ÷ 12 and n = number of months.

Principal	APR	Term (months)	Monthly payment	Total paid	Total interest
$5,000	6%	24			
$5,000	12%	24			
$5,000	22%	24			
$5,000	12%	36			
$3,000	11%	24			
$3,000	3%	24			

Two short responses:

1. Why does paying longer (24 → 36 months at the same APR) usually cost MORE in total interest, even though the monthly payment is lower? _____

1. If you needed inventory but the only available loan was at 22% APR, what's a question you should ask before signing? _____

Activity 2.2 — Friends-and-Family Note Reading

Read the sample F&F note in the program assets. Pick three clauses. For each, write a plain-language paraphrase.

Clause 1 (name it): _____

Plain-language paraphrase: _____

Clause 2 (name it): _____

Plain-language paraphrase: _____

Clause 3 (name it): _____

Plain-language paraphrase: _____

Reflection (2–3 sentences): What would a written F&F note protect both parties from, that a handshake would not?

Activity 2.3 — Funding Comparison Pack (Checkpoint 2)

Sample venture: a hypothetical teen-run custom T-shirt printing operation needing $3,000 ($1,800 inventory + $1,200 entry-level heat press).

Fill in:

	Bootstrap (founder's $3,000 savings)	Loan ($3,000, 11% APR, 24 mo.)	F&F ($3,000, 3% APR, 24 mo.)
Total dollar cost over 24 months	(opportunity cost — what could the savings earn elsewhere?)	(principal + total interest)	(principal + total interest)
Control implication			
Risk if business fails			
Recovery time if you need to walk away			

Recommendation memo (1 paragraph):

To: [Founder name — fictional] From: [Your name] Re: Funding recommendation for the T-shirt venture Date: __

Recommendation: _____

Reasoning (3 sentences — strongest reason, second-strongest, strongest counterargument and why it doesn't change the call):

1.
2.
3.

Risk we are accepting: _____

Decision criteria (one sentence — what evidence would change the recommendation): _____

Unit 3 — Who owns what, and how do we decide?

Activity 3.1 — Operating Agreement Clause Paraphrase

For each clause excerpt from the program-asset operating agreement, write a plain-language version.

Clause A — Capital contributions. "Each Member shall contribute the amount listed in Schedule A as initial capital. No additional capital contributions shall be required without unanimous Member consent."

Plain English: _____

Clause B — Voting rights and decision rules. "Routine operational decisions may be made by the Managing Member. Major decisions — defined as any expense above $500, any change to the business model, any addition of a new Member — require unanimous Member consent."

Plain English: _____

Clause C — Distributions. "Distributions of available cash shall be made quarterly in proportion to Member ownership percentages, after retention of working capital reserves equal to two months of operating expenses."

Plain English: _____

Clause D — Exit (buy-sell). "In the event a Member wishes to exit the Company, the remaining Member shall have the right of first refusal to purchase the exiting Member's interest at fair market value, determined by a third-party valuation."

Plain English: _____

Activity 3.2 — Operating Agreement Pack — Two-Person Template (Checkpoint 3)

For a hypothetical 2-person Capstone partnership, fill in:

1. Members and ownership split

Member A (fictional name): ____ **Ownership:** ___%

Member B (fictional name): ____ **Ownership:** ___%

Reason for the split (1–2 sentences): _____

2. Roles and responsibilities (RACI lite)

Function	Member A	Member B
Sales / customer outreach		
Operations / fulfillment		
Money / bookkeeping		
Marketing / brand		

(Mark each cell as R = responsible, A = accountable, C = consulted, I = informed.)

3. Decision rules

Routine decisions are made by: _____

Major decisions (any expense above $__, **any pivot, any new member) require:** _____

If we deadlock, our process is: _____

4. Money handling

We split distributions: ☐ proportionally to ownership ☐ equally ☐ other: ____

Distributions are paid: ☐ monthly ☐ quarterly ☐ annually ☐ when available

We keep reserves of: ____ months of operating expenses before distributing.

Bank account signature authority: ☐ both members required for any expense ☐ either member up to $___ ☐ Managing Member only

5. Exit / buy-sell

If one member wants out, the other has: _____

The exit price is set by: ☐ formula (3× last 12 months' net income) ☐ third-party valuation ☐ mutual agreement ☐ other

Notice required before exit: _____ days.

Activity 3.3 — Sole Prop vs. LLC Comparison

For each of the three sample ventures, fill in your call and your reasoning.

Venture 1 — Teen running a once-a-month dog-walking service in the neighborhood

Criterion	Sole prop	LLC
Setup cost		
Setup complexity		
Liability exposure		
Best fit (educational, not advisory)		

My call: ☐ Sole prop ☐ LLC

Reasoning (2 sentences): _____

Venture 2 — College student running an SAT-tutoring service that meets in homes

Criterion	Sole prop	LLC
Setup cost		
Setup complexity		
Liability exposure		
Best fit (educational, not advisory)		

My call: ☐ Sole prop ☐ LLC

Reasoning: _____

Venture 3 — Small food-truck operation with weekly customer interactions and food-safety exposure

Criterion	Sole prop	LLC
Setup cost		
Setup complexity		
Liability exposure		
Best fit (educational, not advisory)		

My call: ☐ Sole prop ☐ LLC

Reasoning: _____

For your own Capstone: ☐ Sole prop ☐ LLC ☐ Need more information

What would change my call: _____

What's a real-world question I'd want to ask a lawyer (not Cash, not my teacher) before deciding: _____

Activity 3.4 — Brand Guide One-Pager

Build a 1-page brand guide for your Capstone.

Venture name: _____

Why this name (one sentence): _____

Tagline (≤ 10 words): _____

What this tagline communicates that the name doesn't: _____

Two-color palette:

Primary color: _____ (hex or descriptor)

Secondary color: _____ (hex or descriptor)

Why this combination: _____

One font (with a backup):

Primary font: _____

Why: _____

One voice rule:

"In our writing, we always [____] **and we never [**_____]."

Example sentence in our voice: _____

Example sentence we would never use: _____

Unit 4 — Premortem and the month-in-review

> **"Revenue is loud. Contribution margin is true. Compute one number this week."**
>
> - CASH, GRADE 10

Activity 4.1 — The Premortem

Premise: It is one year from today. Your Capstone has failed.

Step 1 — Generate broadly. Without filtering, list every plausible reason. Aim for 8–10.

1.
2.
3.
4.
5.
6.
7.
8.
9.
10.

Step 2 — Rank top 3. Of the list above, which 3 are the most likely to actually happen?

Rank	Risk	Likelihood (1–5)	Impact (1–5)	Mitigation (one specific action I can take now)
1				
2				
3				

Step 3 — Tier 2 risk (advanced, optional): A less-likely but very high-impact risk worth flagging.

Risk: _____

Why I'd watch for it: _____

Activity 4.2 — Compliance Map (Checkpoint 4 component)

For your Capstone (hypothetical or real-as-design), fill in:

Compliance category	Applies? Y/N	Reason	Agency to consult
Business license			
Sales tax			
ID-required products			
Age limits (operator + customer)			
PII protection			

Reflection (3–4 sentences): What compliance category would you nail down first if you were going to launch for real? Why?

Activity 4.3 — Month-in-Review (5 metrics)

Imagine your Capstone has been running for one month. Fill in:

Metric	This month (actual or projected)	Last month (or starting baseline)	Change	Why?
Revenue				
Customers				
Cost (variable + fixed)				
Time spent (hours)				
Satisfaction (1–10)				

Two changes I'd propose for next month:

1.
2.

For each change, what's the leading indicator I'd watch to know if it worked?

1.
2.

Activity 4.4 — Vision Statement + Pushback Capture

Vision statement (≤ 60 words):

In 12 months, our venture exists to _____

Success looks like _____

We will know we're on track when _____

Pushback capture (after defense):

Pushback #1 received during defense: _____

My response in the moment: _____

What I'd actually change in the vision (1–2 sentences): _____

Pushback #2 received during defense: _____

My response in the moment: _____

What I'd actually change in the vision (1–2 sentences): _____

Activity 4.5 — End-of-Year Reflection

(Use the Reflection Writing Rubric criteria — specificity, revised thinking, honest naming of difficulty, forward-looking specificity, voice and ownership.)

The biggest thing I learned this year was _____

One assumption I had in Week 1 that didn't survive evidence was _____

The hardest part of this year was _____

I'm proud of _____

Before Grade 11, I'm going to keep working on _____

If I had to give one piece of advice to next year's Grade 10 student, it would be _____

AN INTERLUDE · GRADE 10

"Most adults skip this step. You won't."

the band's working assumption.

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Vocabulary Spine — Year-Running List (22 weight-bearing terms)

Add the date you first encountered each term. Add a one-sentence definition and one-sentence example.

#	Term	Date	One-sentence definition	One-sentence example
1	Hobby			
2	Side hustle			
3	Small business			
4	Startup			
5	Bootstrap			
6	Principal			
7	Interest (APR)			
8	Friends-and-family round			
9	Sole proprietorship			
10	LLC			
11	S-corp (intro)			
12	Operating agreement			
13	Member			
14	Manager			
15	Pass-through taxation			
16	Liability			
17	Premortem			
18	Business license			
19	Sales tax			
20	PII			
21	Jurisdiction			
22	Vision statement			

Cash Asks (recurring prompts between sections)

Throughout the year, Cash will appear with a question. There's no "right" answer. Cash wants to see your evidence and your reasoning.

> **CASH ASKS**
> **Which people, and how do you know? Show me the evidence.**

> **CASH ASKS**
> **If this fails in a year, what's the most likely cause? What would you do about it now?**

> **CASH ASKS**
> **Is this a hobby today and a side hustle in 18 months? What would have to change?**

> **CASH ASKS**
> **Whose money is at risk in this funding choice — and whose relationship?**

> **CASH ASKS**
> **If your partner and you disagree about the money next August, what does the agreement say?**

> **CASH ASKS**
> **Which compliance category did you forget? It's almost always one. Which one is yours?**

> **CASH ASKS**
> **Tell me what they actually said when you described the venture. Their words, not your interpretation.**

When you see one of these, stop, write a 2–3 sentence honest answer in the Capstone Journal, and come back. The questions are the spine of the year.

Senior expert upgrade pack — Deliberate practice (Grade 10)

Practice A — Categorization at scale

Categorize 6 ventures with evidence:

Venture	Hobby / Side hustle / Small biz / Startup	Evidence
Etsy seller doing $200/month		
Dog walker with 5 weekly clients		
Local coffee shop with 4 employees		
Tech startup raising VC, pre-revenue		
YouTube channel with 100k subs, $0 revenue		
Your own Capstone		

Practice B — Three funding sources, one venture

For your Capstone (or hypothetical), compare:

	Bootstrap savings	Small loan	Friends + family
Cost (interest, control, social risk)			
What's at risk			
Speed to launch			
When this is the right pick			

Recommendation for your venture: ___

Practice C — Operating agreement for a 2-person teen partnership

Fill the template:

1. **Roles.** Founder 1 is responsible for **; Founder 2 is responsible for** .
2. **Decisions.** Decisions over $ **require both. Decisions under $** are individual.
3. **Money handling.** Revenue goes to __ account. Expenses approved by __.
4. **Splits.** Profit splits **% /** %, based on __.

5. **Exit.** If a founder leaves, **. Buy-out value calculated by** .

Practice D — Premortem on your own venture

"It's one year from now. Your venture failed. What killed it?"

List every reason you can think of (10+):

1. __
2. __
3. __
4. __
5. __
6. __
7. __
8. __
9. __
10. __

Rank top 3 most likely. For each, write one mitigation step.

Practice E — 1-page brand guide

Element	Choice	Why
Name		
Tagline (5 words or less)		
Color 1		
Color 2		
Font (or font-feel)		
Voice rule (one sentence)		

ENDNOTES & STANDARDS

Citations and alignment

Grade 10 cites 3-6 standards across CCSS, Jump$tart, CEE, CASEL, and C3 frameworks. Detailed alignment lives in the master Standards Alignment Map.

1. **Jump$tart Coalition Personal Finance Standards (2021 ed.).** Spending and Saving; Credit and Debt; Employment and Income; Investing; Risk Management and Insurance; Financial Decision Making.
2. **Council for Economic Education (CEE).** Voluntary National Content Standards in Economics.
3. **CCSS-ELA, Grades 11-12.** W.11-12.1, W.11-12.4, SL.11-12.1, SL.11-12.4, RST.11-12.7.
4. **CCSS-Math.** N-Q.1-3 (Reasoning with Quantities), S-IC (Statistics & Inferences), F-IF (Functions), MP.4 (Modeling).
5. **CASEL Core Competencies.** Self-Awareness, Self-Management, Social Awareness, Relationship Skills, Responsible Decision-Making.
6. **C3 Framework for Social Studies State Standards.** Dimension 2 (Economics, Civics) at the high-school grade band.
7. **NGSS-ETS Engineering Practices.** ETS1 (Engineering Design) for the test-and-iterate spine of the year.
8. **Cash to Company Master Scope & Sequence.** 13 grades x 8 strands x 36 weeks; outcomes quoted verbatim from _master/00_Master_Scope_and_Sequence.md.
9. **Cash Mascot Style Guide.** 9-12 voice rules: multi-sentence arguments; vocabulary includes unit economics, runway, premortem, MVP; never flatters, never promises wealth.
10. **Sensitivity protocol.** No probing of family finances; financial scenarios framed as hypothetical for a sample household, business, or scenario.

One promise.

Cash to Company makes one promise: students who move t
program will be clearer thinkers about money and entrepren
matter what they end up doing for a living.

We do not promise wealth. We do not promise success. We pro

> **“The legal, financial, and operational chassis under every venture.”**

- CASH, GRADE 10

For educational use. This curriculum is informational and does not constitute financial, legal, or tax advice. Standards alignment cited per the Cash to Company Standards Alignment Map (Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, CASEL, NGSS-ETS).